

Cats risk perfect record in El Paso

Special to the Citizen

EL PASO — Although Arizona's Wildcats are unanimous in their low regard for Dudley Field, the venerable shrine to mediocre baseball has been quite kind.

UA has never lost a baseball game to Texas-El Paso's Miners in 18 tries on the slightly-less-than-hallowed ground at Dudley Field. And this is no time to start.

Coach Jerry Kindall's Wildcats, 34-9-1 overall, attempt to keep pace with Arizona State in the Western Athletic Conference Southern Division race in a three-game series here tomorrow and Saturday.

UA, 9-3 in the WAC's Southern Division, meets UTEP's lowly Miners, 15-23 overall, 0-12 in league play and riding the crest of a 12-game WAC losing streak, in a single game at noon (Tucson time) tomorrow and a doubleheader at the same time Saturday. KTUC radio will broadcast all three games.

UA swept the Miners earlier in Tucson by scores of 23-4, 11-4 and 20-1 and will need to repeat this time around while keeping an eye on loop-leading ASU's series against New Mexico at Albuquerque.

The Wildcats will have to be on guard against an upset loss to UTEP and at the same time hope for a New Mexico upset which could close the three-game gap between UA and ASU (12-0) prior to next week's (May 8-9-10) windup between the Cats and Sun Devils at Tempe.

The Arizonans started the Miners' long league losing skid and coach Andy Cohen's Miners were demoralized by ASU last weekend, 9-2, 27-4 and 10-1.

"I'm always afraid to go down there (El Paso)," said Kindall. "It's a dangerous situation."

Kindall will open the series tomorrow with right-hander Craig Gioia, who is 7-3 with a 3.78 earned run average but has failed to complete his last two starts.

Kindall said he wasn't certain about his Saturday pitchers, but they could come from Ron Bell (5-2, 5.89), Perry Armstrong (4-1, 2.57) or Steve Powers (10-2, 1.84).

The Miners' pitching, not unexpectedly, is a mess. But Cohen should choose from George Landreth (3-4, 5.28), Ron Wrobel (4-6, 5.73), Jeff Hogan (1-3, 5.80) or perhaps even Dan Modlinski (2-1, 1.77) or Roy Stringer (1-5, 8.90).

The UTEP hurlers will face an Arizona team currently sporting a .333 team batting average, paced by Powers' .400, Dave Stegman's .382, Bob Woodside's .376, Pete Van Horne's .367 and the .360s of Mike Gatlin and Ron Hassey.

Stegman should surpass the school record for stolen bases in a single season this weekend. He tied it with his 29th in a sweep of New Mexico last weekend.

The Miners have dipped to a .259 team batting average and only one Miner, Joe Pennies, is hitting above .300 (.336).

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Citizen Cup

movement gives National boost



Russ Perlich

golf," Perlich says. "He's the best golfer we have."

The "youngsters" are Roger Porzak (1 handicap), Scott Anderson (2), Peter Evans (3) and Perlich (3).

Two-handicapper Al Lothrup will assist Perlich in organizing the team and also will be one of Tucson National's certain starters. Ed Epsen (5) is another starter.

Other possibilities for spots on the eight-man team are Roger DeLaix (5), Spence Maurer (4), Tom Hall (8) and new member Gary Borsch.

Last year Tucson National was eliminated in the second round at Skyline. Perlich is optimistic this year because the Blue Division, which Tucson National is bracketed in, does not visit the tight Skyline course.

Blue Division play opens May 10 at Davis-Monthan, with Tucson National competing against defending champion Randolph Men's Club, Old Pueblo Golf Club, Oro Valley Country Club and Skyline. Second-round play for the Blues is at Tucson Country Club May 11 and the semifinals will be May 17 at the 49ers Country Club.